

Mikhail Stepanov

Head of Backend · Founding Engineer · PhD Candidate

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Moscow

SUMMARY

Backend engineering leader with 9+ years of hands-on experience. Currently Head of Backend at SberEducation. Focus on the management side — leading and growing engineering teams, hiring, and shaping technical strategy, while staying close to the code. Distributed, robust, fault-tolerant services on the JVM stack (Java / Kotlin); cross-stack reach into frontend, mobile (Dart / Flutter), and applied ML / AI. Founding-engineer experience.

EXPERIENCE

SEP 2025 – NOW **Head of Backend**

SberEducation · Moscow

- Hiring, growth and organisational structure for the backend team
- Design system architecture and develop internal platform solutions
- Define technology choices and build technical strategy
- Implement engineering practice, ensure code quality and stability
- Collaborate with the CTO, heads of departments and product teams

JUN 2024 – AUG **Founding Engineer · Tech Lead**

Oneum

- Co-founder and acting CTO; owned backend, ML and frontend
- Designed the system end-to-end and brought Oneum.io to production

FEB 2023 – OCT **Senior Software Engineer**

Align Technology · Yerevan

- Customer-facing backends for clinical and patient-care services
- Split a monolith into a distributed system
- Cross-functional process changes, hiring, sprint and release reviews

NOV 2020 – FEB **Software Engineer**

Align Technology · Moscow

- Microservices for the doctor's portal; scrum-master role
- Sprint planning and progress reviews across the team
- Java, Spring, AWS, Heroku, Docker, PostgreSQL, Redis, Kafka, RabbitMQ

AUG 2020 – SEP **Lecturer**

GeekBrains

- Lectures on system architecture, Java and the Spring Framework

DEC 2019 – NOV **Java Developer**

Business Environment · SberBank · Moscow

- Backend for an educational online platform on Java 8 + Play
- Microservice architecture, code reviews, GraphQL, Grafana, Kibana

FEB 2019 – NOV **Junior Java Developer**

E-COM · Moscow

- Backend for an enterprise document-management system in retail
- Java 8, Spring, ElasticSearch, RabbitMQ, PostgreSQL

AUG 2017 – FEB 2018 **Performance Test Engineer**

Аплана · Moscow

- Performance scripts in C and Java for banking software
- LoadRunner, JMeter, Java stubs

EDUCATION

2022 – 2025 **PhD candidacy, System Analysis**
HSE University · defense pending

2020 – 2022 **MSc, Business Informatics**
HSE University

2019 – 2020 **Exchange student · Cyber Security**
BTU Cottbus-Senftenberg

2016 – 2020 **BSc, Computer Science**
HSE University

SKILLS

Java · Kotlin · Spring · Apache Kafka · RabbitMQ · PostgreSQL · Redis · Docker · Kubernetes · AWS · Heroku · ElasticSearch · GraphQL · Flutter · Applied ML

CERTIFICATIONS

- Reactive Architecture III · IV · V
- Docker Mastery – Kubernetes + Swarm
- Foundations of Project Management

LANGUAGES

- English – full professional
- Russian – native
- German – elementary